Woolworth's Kept Its Dime Ceiling for more than 50 years. Here's What It Never Told Them

A one-page worksheet for the film. Figures marked demo come from the Tarnhollow demo catalogue: demo data, not a client and not a result.

TRY IT THIS WEEK

1. Pick your top products by revenue.
2. For each one, pull its price and units by period, as far back as you have, and divide each period's units by its days.
3. Leave out stockouts, big deals and launches.
4. Check the rule: has the spread of its prices reached 2% of their average, over at least 5 periods? If not, you have a dime.
5. Write it down.
6. For the ones that have moved, fit the line: the log of units a day against the log of price.
7. Read the slope and its range: its standard error, times the multiplier for your number of periods, which the course's spreadsheet gives you. If the slope is shallower than minus one, the direction is up. If the range is clear of minus one, the top is your costs that don't move with price, divided by what the share-of-price fees leave you, times the slope over one plus the slope: step toward it. If the range reaches minus one, work that formula at the estimate alone: above today's price, step up; below it, hold. Either way, by no more than 5%.
8. Before you take the step, write down the units you expect: today's, times one plus the step, raised to the slope.
9. While it's live, watch your conversion, and on Amazon your Buy Box share; if either drops, reverse the step.
10. When the period ends, add it to the history and fit again. And if no price on the curve makes your margin, the cost is the thing to move, the way Woolworth's buyers moved the ring and the toy.

THE NUMBERS IN IT

Figure	What it is	Source
2% (demo data)	price movement the fit needs before it will speak	ELASTICITY.FIT on Tarnhollow demo data (seed 42, as of 2026-09-01)
5 (demo data)	periods the fit needs before it will speak	ELASTICITY.FIT on Tarnhollow demo data (seed 42, as of 2026-09-01)
5% (demo data)	the hard cap on any single price step	PRICE.OPTIMUM on Tarnhollow demo data (seed 42, as of 2026-09-01)

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